

Aynura Erejepbaeva

Prof. Liz

Design Thinking

23 April 2025

Guidelines for the User Interview:

- Ask questions from people who seem to be in leisure (e.g. having free time) on the Green, in dining halls, or any public space.
- Introduction → short questions first → story-based questions (“Describe the last time you had to carry a lot of things to a class or...”, “What classes are you taking and how much do you need to walk/bike?”).
- Don’t take more than 20 minutes per interviewee. Be aware of their time!
- “Why do you think X or Y?”
- Say thank you for their time.

Interview Notes, 4/22 and 4/23:

Jonathan:

- His spring term classes are within the Japanese and the Sciences department. Needs to walk all the way from the Judge dorm hall to Baker library with his satchel.
- Needs to carry a lot of papers and his laptop.
- “I felt so frustrated, the strap got torn apart when I was walking to a class one time”
- My water bottle doesn’t fit at all, and it’s not the best satchel for sports and physical activities.

Lila:

- She is taking classes from the Physics department and Reed Hall. She needs to carry a lot of papers, and likes taking a biscuit or some fruits from FOCO to eat as a snack in her backpack.
- She likes climbing over a tree, or randomly sitting on the Green, and wants her backpack to be clean and neat.
- “My frustration is that my shoulders hurt a lot after classes, and after washing it, it gets very out of shape.”

Nathaniel:

- Takes classes in the Math department and Physics department.
- Medium-sized backpack. Carries one binder, two folders, an ipad, a laptop, two notebooks, several pencils, and a water bottle.

- “I have a lot of binders, which are big and I have a lot of small items in there as well like they get tangled, or my books get smushed.”
- Hard to get things out from the bottom of the backpack.
- Wants efficiency (small backpack but can fit a lot).
- Hard to run with a backpack.
- He likes running, and wishes there was something to put his phone in besides his pocket.
- “I take a granola package but sometimes it gets all over the place in my backpack.

Zack:

- Math department, Physics department, and Cummings
- “Today I had to pack a lot, and I always think about if there could be a place to put my coffee when I’m trying to grab something from my backpack”
- I don’t bring my backpack everywhere besides classes, I usually leave it in my frat.
- I really get frustrated when my things are disorganized.
- “It’s not cool to bring a backpack to a party, for example, so I wish there could be a small thing to put in my phone.”

<https://vlix.io/video/8b4d223ceca17ce3865e/>